

PHILHEALTH CIRCULARNo. 2025- 0023

TO : PHILHEALTH MEMBERS, HEALTH FACILITIES, HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS, PHILHEALTH HEAD OFFICE, PHILHEALTH REGIONAL OFFICES AND ALL OTHERS CONCERNED

SUBJECT : Granting of Provisional Contracting for Z-Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants and Other Special Privileges to Healthcare Facilities, Healthcare Professionals, and PhilHealth Members Affected by the October 10, 2025 Davao Oriental Earthquake

I. RATIONALE

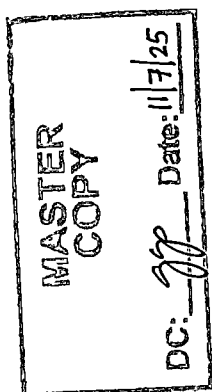
One of the Guiding Principles and Objectives of R.A. No. 7875 as amended by R.A. Nos. 9241 and 10606, and R.A. No. 11223, is that "the Government shall provide public health services for all groups" such as "displaced communities and communities in environmentally-endangered areas" including those affected by calamities such as typhoons, floods, earthquakes and all other natural and/or man-made calamities. The inherent destructive powers of these events cause displacement of communities accompanied by serious health conditions in endangered areas.

The recent earthquake that occurred in the Eastern part of the island of Mindanao last October 10, 2025 caused massive destruction of property and serious physical injuries to the residents of the area. On 13 October 2025, the Provincial Government of Davao Oriental has declared the province under a State of Calamity through Sangguniang Panlalawigan Resolution No. 18-152-10-2025 to facilitate emergency measures and enable immediate delivery of assistance to affected areas.

While PhilHealth already covers hospitalization expenses for surgical procedures, there are only two accredited institution providing Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants and both are located in Davao City.

The Corporation, through the approval of its Board of Directors on October 29, 2025, granted provisional accreditation for Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants to allow institutions in the area to claim these orthopedic implants for those injured during the State of Calamity.

This is consistent with the mandate of the Corporation to provide responsive health care benefits to its members at all times particularly during state of calamities where immediate and urgent healthcare is most needed.



II. OBJECTIVES

This PhilHealth Circular (PC) is issued to ensure immediate and continuous access to PhilHealth Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants and to provide other special privileges in order to aid our members in the affected area for as long as a State of Calamity exists.

III. SCOPE

This policy shall cover the grant of provisional contracting for PhilHealth Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants Claims (for surgery only and excluding rehabilitation) for those affected by the October 10, 2025 Davao Oriental earthquake and its aftershocks for the duration of the declared State of Calamity ("Earthquake").

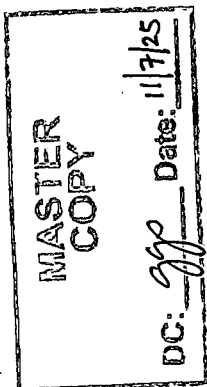
PhilHealth shall also extend special privileges on claims submission even for discharges made 60 days before the earthquake. (Section V.G. item no.3 of this policy)

IV. DEFINITION OF TERMS

- A. **Members** - PhilHealth-registered and non-registered PhilHealth Members including their dependents for orthopedic injuries requiring implants sustained during the earthquake.
- B. **Health Facilities (HFs)** - for purposes of this policy, PhilHealth-accredited and Non-PhilHealth-accredited HFs with DOH License, either privately-owned or government-owned.
- C. **Health Care Professionals (HCPProf)** - for purposes of this policy, PhilHealth-accredited orthopedic surgeons.

V. POLICY STATEMENTS

- A. The period of provisional contracting is for a limited period only which will start on October 10, 2025 and shall end once the declaration of "State of Calamity" in Davao Oriental is lifted.
- B. The coverage of the provisional contracting shall be limited to orthopedic injuries requiring implants sustained during the earthquake.
- C. HFs shall accomplish the Letter of Undertaking (LOU) Annex A) and have it notarized for application of this Circular duly signed by the Medical Director or the Chief of Hospital or any authorized representative, in coordination with PhilHealth Regional Office (PRO) XI.
- D. PRO XI shall undertake the following actions upon receipt of the LOU:
 - 1. PRO XI Regional Vice President (RVP) shall evaluate and decide on the grant of provisional accreditation within the same day. If approved, PRO XI RVP shall sign the LOU and electronically forward a copy of the LOU on the same



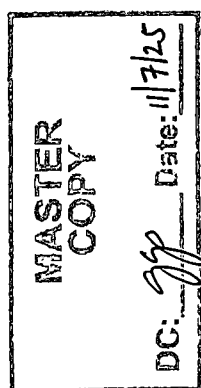
day to the Senior Vice-President for Operations and the Chief Operating Officer (COO) for monitoring purposes, copy furnished the President and CEO (PCEO).

2. PRO XI shall further electronically forward a copy of the approved LOU to the Office of the Senior Vice President of Health Finance Policy Sector (HFPS) through its concerned department for system tagging.
3. The approval of the PRO XI RVP on the LOU shall include the effectivity date of provisional accreditation, the special privileges granted based on the specific situation of the requesting HF, and any negotiated fees for co-payment, if any.
4. The PCEO shall have the authority to modify or otherwise veto/reverse the approval of the RVP through an official written notice to the same within two (2) working days from receipt of the LOU.

E. Membership and Contributions

Based on prevailing PhilHealth policies¹, the following provisions applicable in similar situations (e.g. earthquake, force majeure) remain in effect:

1. Existing rules on membership, declaration of qualified dependents and premium contribution rates and remittances shall remain in effect, unless an exemption is granted in writing by the Corporation.
2. Filipinos in affected areas shall be given the privilege to avail of full range of services during the Earthquake regardless of the type of accommodations in both public and private health facilities.
3. The Member Data Record (MDR) is no longer required in the availment of PhilHealth benefits.
4. For patients with no PhilHealth Identification Number (PIN) or not yet registered to PhilHealth, HFs shall attach to their claims a properly accomplished PhilHealth Membership Registration Form (PMRF) along with appropriate supporting documents, if available. The said claims shall be submitted manually by the HFs to PRO XI.
5. HFs shall be authorized to facilitate the electronic submission of PMRF and supporting documents for the registration and updating of records of their respective patients using applicable online platforms.
6. Those availing of PhilHealth benefits with unpaid premium contributions shall be billed later in accordance with pertinent policies on the generation, issuance, and settlement of the Statement of Premium Account (SPA).



¹PhilHealth Circular Nos. 2020-0007 [Guidelines on the Provisions of Special Privileges to those Affected by a Fortuitous Event (Revision 1)] and 2021-0010 (Handling of Employer Requests to Compromise, Waive or Release, in Whole or in Part, Interests and/or Surcharges and Payment of Premium Arrears through Installment Arrangements)

7. Non-payment of the prescribed premium contributions within the deadline shall not be subjected to applicable interests and penalties.
8. Those without the capacity to pay the prescribed premium contributions may be referred to the Medical Social Workers (MSWs) of the public and private hospitals or any Local Social Welfare Development Officers (LSWDOs) for assessment using the intake survey tool of the Department of Health (DOH) or Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD).

F. Benefit Entitlement Regarding Existing Inpatient, Outpatient and Other Packages:

1. The No Co-Payment Policy shall apply to all patients admitted in basic accommodation following Republic Act (R.A.) No. 11223 or the Universal Health Care Act, in all PhilHealth-accredited government and private HFs. Private HFs are highly encouraged to observe the No Co-Payment Policy during the period of the State of Calamity.
2. Existing case rates and packages will apply for non-orthopedic injuries requiring implants incurred during the State of Calamity.
3. Existing case rates and packages will apply for all other conditions deemed not due to the earthquake.
4. HFs must ensure that there is a competent HCProf that will handle the immediate post-operative care of all patients. For subsequent care, patients may be referred to facilities contracted for PhilHealth benefits for physical therapy and rehabilitation.

G. Special Privileges

1. In lieu of existing contracting requirements for Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants, a LOU for provisional contracting shall be accomplished by the HFs that will govern this contracting arrangement.

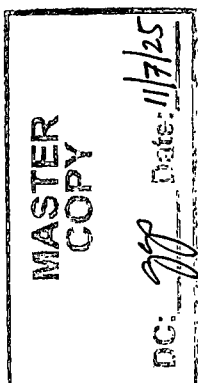
This will ensure availability of the said benefit package even in healthcare institutions that are not contracted for it.

2. Healthcare Professionals will be compensated regardless of where they perform the procedure.

Healthcare professionals will be allowed to claim PhilHealth benefits even if they perform the procedures in institutions that they are not originally affiliated with, provided that hospital management gives them that privilege.

3. Submission of Claims within 120 calendar days from the date of discharge

This provision from PhilHealth Circular 2020-0007 shall continue to apply. The 120-day extension for claim submission covers discharges that occurred up to 60 calendar days before the earthquake (October 10, 2025), as well as



all discharges after the earthquake and up to the lifting of the Declaration of State of Calamity.

4. Requirements for claims for the Z Benefit for Selected Orthopedic Implants will be simplified to include only Forms 1, 2, and the operative record.
5. Exemption to the less than 24-hour confinement rule

As adapted from PhilHealth Circular 2020-0007, these cases may be reimbursed based on the current rules of reimbursement.

6. The Corporation may provide additional special privileges after further assessment of the impact of the Earthquake. It shall issue the necessary amendments to this circular or a Supplemental PhilHealth Circular accordingly.

H. Monitoring and Evaluation

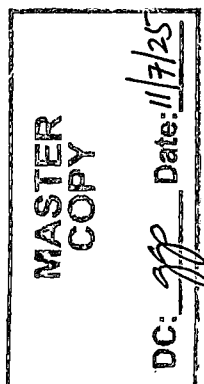
1. The health care providers shall be subjected to the following rules on monitoring and performance evaluation as provided for in:
 - a. PC No. 2018-0019: Health Care Provider Performance Assessment System (HCP PAS) Revision 2;
 - b. PC No. 2022-0012: Contracting of a Health Facility as a Z Benefit Provider (Revision 1); and
 - c. PC No. 2023-0012: Omnibus Guidelines on the Accreditation of Health Facilities (HFs) to the National Health Insurance Program.
2. The PRO XI shall submit a monthly monitoring and utilization report to the OPCEO, copy furnished the OEVPCCO and the Office of the Senior Vice-President for the Health Finance Policy Sector (HFPS).

I. This policy shall be regularly reviewed and enhanced as necessary.

J. As frequent earthquakes affect our country, this policy, "Granting of Provisional Contracting for Z-Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants and Other Special Privileges to Healthcare Facilities, Healthcare Professionals, and PhilHealth Members," may be applied to other areas/regions wherein a State of Calamity due to the effects of an earthquake has been declared by either the national or local government unit.

VI. PENALTY CLAUSE

Any violation of this PhilHealth Circular shall be dealt with and penalized in accordance with pertinent provisions of Republic Act (R.A.) No. 7875 as amended, R.A. No. 11223 and their respective Implementing Rules and Regulations.



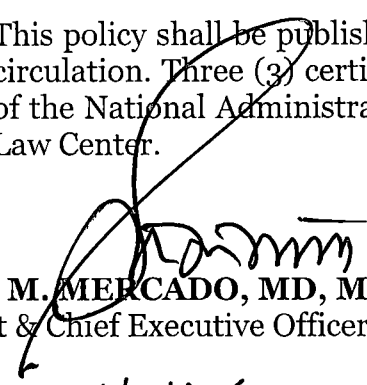
VII. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE

In the event that any part or provision of this PhilHealth Circular is declared unauthorized or rendered invalid by any Court of Law or competent authority, those provisions not affected by such declaration shall remain valid and effective.

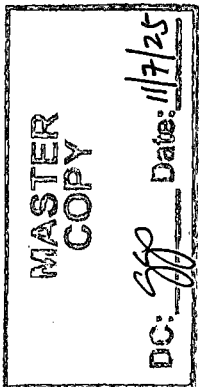
VIII. DATE OF EFFECTIVITY

This PhilHealth Circular shall take effect immediately.

This policy shall be published in the Official Gazette or in any newspaper of general circulation. Three (3) certified true copies shall thereafter be deposited to the Office of the National Administrative Register (ONAR) at the University of the Philippines Law Center.


EDWIN M. MERCADO, MD, MHA, MMSc
President & Chief Executive Officer

Date signed: 11/06/2025



Granting of Provisional Contracting for Z-Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants and Other Special Privileges to Healthcare Facilities, Healthcare Professionals, and PhilHealth Members Affected by the October 10, 2025 Davao Oriental Earthquake

Annex A: Letter of Undertaking (LOU)

Letter of Undertaking (LOU)
as Provider of Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants
for Earthquake victims in (name of province)

Date: _____

NAME OF RVP

PRO _____

Address

Dear RVP _____:

We, the _____ Name of Health Facility, with address at _____ would like to signify our intent to be a PhilHealth contracted Provider of Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants (Tranche 1) services:

1. Implants for Hip Arthroplasty

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011A	Total Hip Prosthesis, cemented	189,000	
Z011B	Total Hip Prosthesis, cementless	234,000	
Z011C	Partial Hip Prosthesis, bipolar	207,000	
Z011J	Total Hip Prosthesis, hybrid	207,000	
Z011K	Partial Hip Prosthesis, unipolar modular	189,000	

2. Implants for Hip Fixation

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011D	Multiple screw fixation (MSF) 6.5mm cannulated cancellous screws with washer	144,000	

3. Implants for Pertrochanteric Fracture

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011E	Compression Hip Screw Set (CHS) or	135,000	
Z011F	Proximal Femoral Locked Plate (PFLP) or	144,000	
Z011I	Proximal Femoral Nail (PFN)	144,000	

MASTER COPY

DC: *gfp* Date: *11/7/25*

4. Implants for Femoral and Tibial Shaft Fracture

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011G1	Intramedullary Nail with Interlocking Screws - Femur	126,000	
Z011G2	Intramedullary Nail with Interlocking Screws - Tibia	126,000	
Z011H1	Locked compression plate - broad, metaphyseal, proximal and distal tibial	135,000	
Z011H2	Locked compression plate - broad, metaphyseal, proximal and distal femoral	135,000	

5. Implants for Total Knee Replacement

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011L	Knee Prosthesis	225,900	

6. Implants for Upper Extremities

Package Code	Description	Z Package Rate	Co-payment Rate
Z011M1	Arm and forearm, plating	105,300	
Z011M2	Arm and forearm, pinning	90,000	
Z011N1	Wrist, plating	111,600	
Z011N2	Wrist, pinning	95,400	

Further, we hereby commit that:

1. Our facility has the capability and necessary licenses/permits to provide the above services;
2. Our facility shall ensure healthcare professionals (HCPs) has the necessary qualification to render the above services including post-operative care.
3. We acknowledge that PhilHealth shall pay for the services through Z benefit package rate (tranche 1) as stipulated in PhilHealth Circular No.2023-0007: Z Benefits for Selected Orthopedic Implants (Revision 2);
4. We agree with the set rates as stipulated in PhilHealth Circular No.2023-0007 and shall apply the “no co-payment” scheme to all patients availing the above-mentioned services in basic/ward accommodation; Co-payment is allowed for private patients or non-basic accommodation only.
5. We will comply with the PhilHealth Circular No: _____ implementing guidelines on the grant of provisional accreditation/contracting and other privileges to health facilities and professionals and PhilHealth members affected by the Earthquake in (name of province) on (date).

MASTER
COPY
DC: gfp Date: 11/7/25

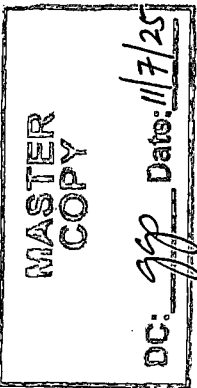
- 6. We agree that the privileges granted for participation shall automatically terminate on the date upon which the officially declared state of calamity is lifted by the appropriate governmental authority.
- 7. We will provide the necessary documents that PhilHealth shall request to facilitate the processing of our claims or in compliance to any monitoring activity being conducted; and
- 8. We will immediately implement the new benefit coverage once in effect

Very truly yours,

Name of Medical Director/Chief of Hospital
Name of Facility:_____
Address:_____

SUBSCRIBED AND SWORN TO before me this ____day of _____, 20____,
in_____, affiant exhibiting to me his/her _____, issued on
_____at_____.

NOTARY PUBLIC
Doc. No._____
Page No._____
Book No._____
Series of 20_____



Approved by:

Name of RVP
PRO: _____
Address:_____

Date signed